

Active Oahu Tours — Human-in-the-Loop Content Workflow

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A practical operations guide for Michael Gulden, Ella Georgeson, and Hermes (AI Agent)

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The Team

Role	Who	What They Do
AI Agent	Hermes	Task assignment, research, question generation, schema markup, technical SEO, content templates, transcription management, batch

Domain Expert	Michael Gulden	planning Records audio interviews, provides local knowledge, final approval on content, business strategy
Content Writer	Ella Georgeson	Writes blog posts/pages, reviews AI-generated content, polishes transcriptions, catches AI mistakes, applies creative judgment

Ella's background: 22-year-old English major, strong writer, new to Oahu. Her fresh eyes are an asset — if something confuses her, it will confuse customers.

The Content Pipeline

Stage 1 — Interview Recording

Owner: Michael (Hermes prepares)

- Hermes writes interview scripts (20-35 questions each) and posts them to Linear as tasks assigned to Michael.
- Each script covers one topic cluster. Example: “Kualoa & Chinaman’s Hat” feeds ~8 web pages.
- Michael records audio (15-25 minutes), answering naturally — like telling a friend about the area.
- Michael uploads the MP3 to the corresponding Linear task.
- **Goal:** 1-2 recordings per week.

What Hermes does in this stage:

- Researches the topic cluster
 - Writes targeted questions that map to specific web pages
 - Posts the script to Linear with clear instructions
 - Nudges if recordings lag (see Warning Signs)
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Stage 2 — Transcription & Extraction

Owner: Hermes

- Swarm transcribes the audio (Gemini / Whisper).
- Extracts:
 - Direct quotes (for pull-quotes and testimonials)
 - Key facts and figures
 - Stories and anecdotes
 - Named entities (locations, landmarks, competitor names)
- Maps each interview section to its corresponding web page.

What Michael does in this stage: Nothing. Hermes handles it end-to-end.

What Ella does in this stage: Nothing yet — she picks up the output in Stage 3.

Stage 3 — Content Creation

Owner: Ella + Hermes (collaborative)

1. Hermes provides content templates with Michael's transcribed insights embedded.
2. Ella writes the actual pages — her creative judgment makes it sound human and engaging.
3. Hermes generates schema markup:
 - FAQ schema
 - HowTo schema
 - Article schema
 - LocalBusiness schema
4. Ella does the final proofread — catches anything that “doesn't sound right.”

Ella's specific responsibilities:

- Write engaging, human-sounding prose
 - Flag sentences that sound generic or AI-generated
 - Polish raw transcription text for readability
 - Ask questions about anything unclear (her confusion = customer confusion)
 - Move completed tasks to “In Review”
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Stage 4 — Review & Publish

Owner: Michael + Hermes

1. Michael reviews final pages for:
 - **Accuracy:** Distances, directions, tide-dependent details
 - **Voice:** Does it sound like him? Does it reflect Active Oahu's personality?
 - **Business goals:** Does it target the right keywords? The right tours?
 2. Hermes handles technical deployment:
 - Git commit and push
 - Cloudflare Pages auto-deploys
 - Verifies live page renders correctly
 3. Content goes live on **activeoahutours.com**.
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Batch Assignment System

Why Batches?

Ella is part-time and a student. Dumping 30 tasks on her guarantees overwhelm and burnout. Batches keep things manageable, focused, and flexible.

Problem	How Batches Solve It
	3–5 tasks at a time is

Overload	manageable alongside school
Scattered focus	A small batch forces priority — one cluster at a time
Review bottlenecks	Michael reviews 3-5 pages, not 30
Rigid planning	Hermes adjusts priorities between batches based on what's working

Batch Rhythm

Hermes assigns 3-5 tasks → Ella works through them → Batch nears completion → Hermes assigns next batch

Batch Roadmap

Batch 1 — Orientation (No recordings needed yet)

- ☐ Read the existing Active Oahu Tours website
- ☐ Review 3-5 competitor websites (Hermes provides list)
- ☐ Read all 6 interview scripts to understand topic clusters
- ☐ Write one practice blog post (Hermes provides template + topic)

Batch 2 — First Content Cluster

- ☐ Write pages from interview cluster #1 (after Michael records it)
- ☐ Review and polish Hermes-provided transcriptions
- ☐ Flag any confusing or unclear source material

Batches 3+ — Rotating Clusters

- ☐ Mix longer blog posts (1,500-2,500 words) with shorter landing pages (800-1,200 words)
- ☐ Hermes prioritizes clusters based on business need (which tours need more bookings?)
- ☐ Every third batch or so: one “evergreen” post not tied to a specific interview

What Humans Do That AI Cannot

Michael Adds

Capability	Why AI Can't Do It
Voice & stories	AI doesn't have 3+ years running a kayak tour company in Kailua. Your actual stories — the time the wind flipped every rental board, the secret launch spot only locals use — that's gold AI cannot generate.
Factual verification	You know the real distances, the tide windows, which routes work in which conditions. AI hallucinates confidently; you

E-E-A-T authority	catch those errors. Google rewards first-hand expertise. Your recorded voice, your name on the content, your real experience — this signals “real business, real person” to search engines.
Business judgment	You know which tours have excess capacity, which competitors are threatening, and what revenue looks like month-to-month. AI can advise; you decide.

Ella Adds

Capability	Why AI Can't Do It
Creative writing quality	AI writes competently. Ella writes <i>engagingly</i> . She understands pacing, hooks, transitions, and voice in ways AI models only approximate.
Fresh eyes for clarity	She's new to Oahu. If she's confused by a description, a customer will be too. Her questions directly improve content clarity.
Taste & judgment	“This sounds corny,” “this paragraph drags,” “this sentence is doing nothing” — subjective quality calls AI cannot reliably make.
Transcription polish	Raw speech-to-text is clunky: filler words, false starts, run-on sentences. Ella shapes it into clean, readable prose while preserving Michael's voice.

Suggested Weekly Cadence

Monday Morning — Hermes

- ☐ Review content pipeline status in Linear
- ☐ If Ella's previous batch is mostly complete: assign next batch
- ☐ Check if any new interview scripts need writing
- ☐ Flag any stalled tasks to Michael

Flexible — Michael's Recording Sessions

- ☐ Pick up one interview task from Linear
- ☐ Find a quiet 15-25 minutes
- ☐ Record naturally — as if telling a friend
- ☐ Upload MP3 to the Linear task

- **Target:** 1-2 recordings per week

Wednesday-Thursday — Ella

- ☐ Write content from her active batch
- ☐ Review any newly available transcriptions
- ☐ Move completed tasks to **In Review**
- ☐ Flag questions or concerns in Linear comments

Thursday-Friday — Michael + Hermes

- ☐ Michael reviews submitted content (accuracy, voice, strategy)
 - ☐ Approve or request revisions in Linear
 - ☐ Hermes pushes approved content live
 - ☐ Plan next week's priorities (which cluster next? any urgent pages?)
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Interview Scripts Ready to Record

These 6 scripts are written and waiting in Linear. Each feeds a content cluster.

#	Linear Task	Topic Cluster	Est. Pages
1	GRO-340	Kualoa & Chinaman's Hat	~8
2	GRO-341	Kaneohe Sandbar	~8
3	GRO-342	North Shore / Sharks Cove	~8
4	GRO-343	Kailua & Lanikai	~8
5	GRO-344	Brand Origin Story	~8
6	GRO-345	Windward Hidden Oahu	~8

Total pipeline: 6 recordings → ~48 web pages of original, expert-driven content.

Suggested recording order: Start with GRO-344 (Brand Origin) — it sets the foundation, and Ella can reference it across all other clusters. Then proceed geographically: GRO-343 (Kailua/Lanikai, your home base), then GRO-341, GRO-340, GRO-345, GRO-342.

Quick-Reference Checklists

Michael: Before You Hit Record

- ☐ Read the interview script once (don't memorize — it's a guide)
- ☐ Find a quiet space (wind noise is the enemy)
- ☐ Use your phone voice memo app or a USB mic
- ☐ Speak naturally — conversational tone, not a lecture
- ☐ It's okay to go off-script if a good story comes up
- ☐ 15-25 minutes is the sweet spot; don't overthink it
- ☐ Upload the MP3 directly to the Linear task

Ella: Starting a New Content Task

- ☐ Read the Hermes-provided template first
- ☐ Review the relevant transcription excerpts
- ☐ Check the target page's purpose (informational? commercial? local?)
- ☐ Write a first draft — focus on flow, not perfection
- ☐ Read it aloud once. Does it sound natural?
- ☐ Move to "In Review" when satisfied

Hermes: Batch Assignment Checklist

- ☐ Previous batch $\geq$ 70% complete?
- ☐ New batch size: 3–5 tasks, mixed difficulty
- ☐ At least one "quick win" (shorter page) per batch
- ☐ Clear due context on each task
- ☐ No duplicate or overlapping assignments

Warning Signs & Escalation

Warning Sign	What It Means	Action
Ella's tasks sit in "To Do" > 5 days	Batch might be too large, unclear, or she's overwhelmed	Hermes checks in via Linear comment; Michael can also reach out directly
Michael hasn't recorded in 2+ weeks	Content pipeline stalls — no new source material	Hermes sends a friendly nudge via Linear
Content sounds generic or AI-like	Ella's creative judgment feedback loop isn't strong enough yet	Ella should flag 1–2 specific examples with notes on <i>why</i> they feel off. Hermes adjusts templates.
Too many tasks assigned at once	Batch limit not being respected	Either human says "batch limit reached" — Hermes adjusts. This is a feature, not a failure.
Reviews piling up in Michael's queue	Bottleneck at final approval	Hermes flags aging reviews. Consider: can Ella do a first-pass approval on simpler pages?
Ella asking repeated clarification questions	Source material (transcriptions or templates) isn't clear enough	Hermes re-examines templates and extraction quality; may need to improve Stage 2 output

Key Principle

Hermes handles the scaffolding — research, templates, scheduling, technical deployment. The humans handle the substance — stories, voice, accuracy, creative quality.

Neither can do the other's job well. Together they produce content that is **technically optimized AND authentically human** — exactly what Google's E-E-A-T guidelines reward and what competitors relying on pure AI content cannot match.

Contact & Communication

- **Primary workspace:** Linear (tasks, comments, status updates)
 - **Audio uploads:** Directly to Linear task attachments
 - **Live content:** activeoahutours.com (Cloudflare Pages auto-deploy)
 - **Hermes reachable:** Via Linear comments — mention or assign to Hermes
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